



Point-and-shoot

This has been a rather exciting year for point and shoot cameras. The consumer has been demanding more from this segment, pushing manufacturers to get very innovative with not just the design, but features and performance as well – companies had to get creative.

We saw a major influx of many new models this year, but the focus on enthusiast point-and-shoot cameras was obvious – bigger sensors, faster lenses, better optics and control-centric ergonomics.

Point-and-shoots have evolved to the point where they're rivalling entry-level DSLRs – with sensors as large as those on DSLRs, amazing optics and fast apertures, great ISO performance, fast AF systems and even the provision of Hotshoe.

Zero1 winner

Sony RX100 II

Sony took the point-and-shoot (PnS) industry by storm when they introduced the RX100 last year. We thought the camera was pretty much perfect the way it was, but then Sony went ahead and made our favourite PnS even better. The focusing is the fastest we've seen in a PnS, incredible high ISO performance and in the latest addition, a much loved hot-shoe. It even improved video, image quality and retains the incredibly compact form factor that allows it to slip into a pocket.

Worthy mentions

Fujifilm X20

It's almost as pricey as the RX100-II, but a camera for a whole different league. The Fujifilm X20 is designed



▲ POINT-AND-SHOOT CAMERA: SONY RX100 II

Price: ₹42,000



Fujifilm X20

Price: ₹40,000



Olympus Stylus XZ-2

Price: ₹31,000

like an old time rangefinder and sports a 2/3 inch sensor and a 28-112mm f/2.0-2.8 lens. The fast aperture makes this camera a low-light champion, not requiring the need to go to obscenely high ISO numbers. We love the camera for its design, for its really good performance and our penchant for nostalgia.

Olympus Stylus XZ-2

The Olympus XZ-2 is a little known camera in our circles, but those of us who have used it, can't stop singing it's praises. It's a 12 megapixel shooter with a 28-112mm f/1.8-2.5 lens. The camera is incredibly quick to focus and thanks to the aperture range, is able to work quite well even in low light. Our favorite part about the XZ2 is just how light it is, and how easy a camera it is to use. Anyone from an amateur to a pro shooter would benefit from having one in their kit bag.



◀ MIRRORLESS CAMERA:

OLYMPUS OM-D E-M1

Price: ₹1,05,000

Mirrorless

These started out as glorified replacement options for point-and-shoot (PnS) cameras, with the added benefit of interchangeable lenses. Over the last five years, they've evolved into a segment that is giving the DSLR market touch competition.

It started with Panasonic, but Olympus, Sony and Fujifilm have since contributed significantly. Fujifilm brought some serious quality lenses to the market while Sony made the technology widely available at very attractive price points. This year, we saw some groundbreaking announcements such as the first full-frame mirrorless camera, the Sony A7, and we